

BLEED AI · STRATEGY PROPOSAL · JULY 2026

Taha LinkedIn Growth Strategy

A 14-day Phase-1 sprint to turn a built-but-dormant LinkedIn engine into a pipeline machine — decided, data-backed, and referenced to the top operators in the space + LinkedIn's own 2025 algorithm research.

Prepared for Taha Anwar, Founder @ Bleed AI. Baseline: 6,795 followers · 0.2% engagement · commenting dormant.
Living document — regenerated from `playbook/STRATEGY-PROPOSAL.md`; the same Drive link updates in place.

Executive summary

Taha's LinkedIn is a **near-complete growth machine that is switched off**. After ~2 years and 9 years in AI, the account sits at **6,795 followers**, **~0.2% engagement**, **939 impressions/week**, **3 profile views/day**, and a **~1% winner rate** — with the single highest-leverage lever, **commenting, completely dormant (0 comments in 14 days)**.

This is not a talent problem or a content problem. It is a **consistency + distribution** problem, and every fix is 100% in our control. We already own more infrastructure than 99% of creators (a corpus of 6,642 analysed posts, two AI drafting skills, a live comment-suggestion tool, a free connection-targeting system, a zero-cost visual pipeline, ~50 competitor lead-magnets, and a full analytics dashboard). We are using almost none of it.

The proposal: a 14-day Phase-1 sprint that turns the engine on — **4 posts/week, ~130 comments, ~130 targeted connections** — using the assets we already built, backed at every step by what the top LinkedIn operators (Lara Acosta, Pierre Herubel, Adam Robinson, Justin Welsh, Jasmin Alić, Ruben Hassid, Casey Brown, Michel Lieben) and LinkedIn's own 2025 algorithm research prove works. We do **not** chase followers in these two weeks — we convert impressions and profile views into **DMs and pipeline**. Video is Phase 2; we earn it by lighting the fire first.

The one-line bet: Off → 4 posts/week + ~130 comments + ~130 connections over 14 days. Prove the engine repeats, then pour fuel on a fire that's already lit.

Validated against every competitor. We reverse-engineered the top-10 *and* worst-10 posts of all 12 top cold-email/outbound creators we track (see the companion *Competitor Strategy Teardown*). Three findings underwrite this plan: (1) the **comment-to-DM lead magnet** ("comment KEYWORD + connect → DM the asset") is the single universal growth mechanic — it drove **500–3,196 comments** on the winners; (2) every winner **owns one contrarian wedge** and repeats it (ours: *signal over volume, systems over copy*); and (3) the losers' worst posts are *exactly Taha's current habit* — dry tips or announcements with **no hook, no proof-number, no comment-gate**, off a consistent lane. This plan does the opposite of the flops and the same as the winners.

1. Where we are now (the honest baseline)

Metric	Now	What it means
Followers	6,795 (+1%/wk ≈ +68)	Plateaued after years
Engagement rate	~0.2%	~99.8% of the audience never reacts
Impressions / 7 days	939	Content is barely distributed
Profile views / 90 days	281 (~3/day)	Almost nobody clicks through
Posts / week	0.7 (weeks-long gaps)	No momentum, no clean signal to the algorithm
Winner rate (score ≥ 80)	~1% (1 of 93)	55% of posts are flops
Comments given / 14 days	0 (dormant)	The #1 growth lever is off

The uncomfortable truths (so we fix the right things): the content is *commodity* — it passes no anti-commodity test (Pierre Herubel), interchangeable with any cold-email account, no point of view, no risk. The one "win" (91 comments) was a giveaway mechanic, not magnetic content. Engagement is partly self-generated (first comment is usually our own second account). **Ambition (#1 cold-email voice) vs behaviour (≤1 post/week, safe tips, no comments) is a chasm.**

The good news, backed by LinkedIn's own 2025 research: the algorithm is now an LLM ("360Brew") that understands you from *text alone* — which means **the beginner's advantage is real** and a small, specific account can now out-perform a big one. The door is open. We just have to walk through it consistently.

2. The positioning — decided (Lara Acosta's SMPV framework, applied)

- **S — Skill:** engineering AI-powered outbound **systems** that book meetings (cold email + Claude Code/Clay/n8n + copy + customer psychology).
- **M — Market:** B2B founders & agency owners, \$500K–\$10M ARR, stuck on referrals or a missing SDR motion.
- **P — Problem:** predictable booked meetings *without* volume-spam, burned domains, or hiring five SDRs.
- **V — Value (the moat):** we actually **run the agency** (real numbers) **and** build the AI version **in public**. Uncopyable.

Stamped positioning: *"The operator who engineers cold-email **systems** that book meetings — and builds them in public with AI."*

The word we own (Matt Gray's "own one word"): **"systems"** — *cold email is a systems problem*. **Anti-commodity test** (Pierre Herubel): a competitor literally cannot post our content, because it is our real build and our real numbers.

3. The content pillars — decided (Pierre Herubel's model: max 3)

Scored from 10 candidates by *unfair advantage* × *highest-median format* × *fixing our gaps*. The three that win:

Pillar	What it is	Backed by
P1 · Build the AI outbound engine in public	Claude Code / Clay / n8n walkthroughs, AI-agents doing SDR work, real builds	Adam Robinson (founder-led), Matt Gray (BTS), Michel Lieben (tool stacks) — the hottest wave in the niche, and it's uncopyable
P2 · Cold-email systems & results, with proof	Teardowns, client case-studies, the real metrics, deliverability	Corpus: case-study = 76 median (2nd highest); Adam Robinson's radical transparency
P3 · Contrarian takes on outbound	Sharp, proof-backed flags (the missing pillar)	Psychology (prediction error → attention); Adam Robinson (polarizing hooks)

+ **one personal / founder-story post per week** (Josh Braun, Lara Acosta — stories are the biggest virals; it's how our 91-comment post behaved).

Weekly mix of ~4 posts: 1 build-in-public · 1 case-study/proof · 1 contrarian · 1 story. (*Pierre's authority-first ~60/25/15, tuned up on contrarian to fix our comment gap.*) Every post ships a lead magnet (first comment) + a visual with a second hook.

The contrarian-take bank — top 5 stamped (each defensible with our real data)

#	The take	Backed by
1	"Volume outbound is dead. 10k emails/day is a deliverability suicide note, not a strategy."	Our signal-based thesis + banner
2	"Your reply rate is a vanity metric. Positive reply rate is the only number that predicts revenue."	Our data (1 lead / ~105 emails; 32% positive reply)
3	"Hiring an SDR army in 2026 is lighting money on fire — one operator + AI agents beats a 5-person team."	Ties to P1; we can <i>show</i> the build
4	"More cold-email tools are making you worse — you're automating a broken process faster."	Our real "\$10k wasted on tools" post
5	"90% of 'personalization' is theater — {first_name} doesn't book meetings, relevance does."	Debate-magnet, on-thesis

4. The hooks — top 5 stamped templates (Ruben Hassid's types + the data)

The rules every hook obeys: the first ~2 lines (~55 chars each, Ruben Hassid's 55-char rule) are everything above the mobile "...see more" fold (~140 chars). **Curiosity + contrarian hooks outperform everything by 2.3x; hooks under 10 words beat longer ones by 40%** (Jasmin Alić: negative-word hooks –30%, never bury the power line). **Every line is a hook** and line 2 must *re-hook* (Lara Acosta).

#	Type	Ready-to-use Taha hook
1	Contradiction	"Sending more cold emails is why you're getting fewer replies." / <i>re-hook</i> : "I killed 80% of our volume last quarter. Positive replies went up."
2	Specific-number (earns saves)	"1 booked meeting per 105 emails. That's the whole game." / "Everyone chasing 10k/day is optimizing the wrong number."
3	Direct-accusation	"Your reply rate is a vanity metric." / "You're celebrating opens while positive-reply rate quietly predicts zero revenue."
4	Stolen-thought (best for DMs)	"I spent \$10k+ on cold-email tools and got worse at cold email." / "Every new tool just automated a broken process faster."
5	Absurd-reframe	"Hiring 5 SDRs in 2026 is lighting money on fire." / "One operator + a few AI agents out-books the whole team — I'll show you the build."

5. The commenting system — the #1 lever (currently OFF)

This is the deepest-leverage tactic and the one nobody can throttle. Jasmin Alić: "Post 7x/week max, but comment 20–30x/day." Casey Brown built a 40K audience where **90% of clients come inbound** off this — one comment thread became **\$1.2M**. We leave **0** comments. Turning this on is the single biggest fix in this document.

The mindset — peer, not fan (Casey Brown): comment on **5–15 posts/day, not 50**. Before each one, run the *coffee-shop test*: "if I were sitting across from this person, what would I actually say?" **Add insight or a strategic question — never praise**. Praise makes you a fan; insight makes you a peer, and clients hire peers. **Never sell in comments**.

The Power List (Casey Brown): one Google Sheet, 4 columns (category · name · profile · last-engaged), **~30 ICP founders + 15 adjacent (RevOps/sales-ops) + 10 cold-email peers + 5 macro (e.g. Adam Robinson)**. We already

have `capture-connects.mjs` that mines commenters into a Connects tab — same principle, automated.

Exactly what to say — the 4 comment types, with real Taha examples

Every comment is **15+ words** (15+-word comments $\approx 2\times$ impact) and posted in the **first 30–60 minutes** (be one of the first 3–5 comments — early engagement is weighted heaviest).

1 • Value-add — expand the post with our own data/tactic:

"We saw the same thing — cutting a client from 4k to 900 emails/day and triggering on live job-change signals took positive replies from 8% to 32%. Fewer sends, better inbox placement, more meetings. Volume was hiding the real problem."

2 • Challenge — respectfully push back, make them reconsider:

"Genuine pushback: doesn't more personalization just move the bottleneck? We A/B'd {first_name} + 'saw your post' against pure relevance-triggered copy — the theatrical stuff didn't move positive-reply rate at all. What are you seeing?"

3 • Supportive — validate, then layer a deeper insight from our build:

"100% on deliverability being the whole game. The part people miss: we run domain warmup + SEG monitoring as an automated Clay→n8n loop, so a burned domain gets pulled before it tanks a campaign. Boring infra, everything."

4 • Witty/relatable — when it fits; people remember how you made them feel:

"'Just send more emails' is the 'have you tried turning it off and on again' of outbound. We all did it, we all burned a domain, we all learned."

The rituals + the data

- **Michel Lieben's 30/30:** 30 min engaging *before* posting; reply to *every* comment on your own post in the *first 30 min* after.
- **The 15-min daily block:** 10 min comment on 5–7 Power-List posts · 5 min reply to your own comments · +5 min move promising threads to DMs · Monday 10 min update the Power List. **Commit 90 days.**
- **Data:** replying to your own comments $\approx$ **+30% engagement**; 10 comments/day for a month $\approx$ **+40% profile visits**; reply within minutes during the golden hour $\approx$ *doubles* comment count when the algorithm is judging.
- **Comment → lead pipeline:** capture commenters (Trigify) → enrich (Clay) → filter to ICP → warm DM (HeyReach). They already engaged, so acceptance and reply crush cold outbound. (*Needs Sophiya's sign-off — same gate as anything that sends.*)

6. Connecting

The play (Michel Lieben, 100k-conversation dataset): send **10–20 personalized ICP requests/day**, but warm the target first — a **profile view / like / follow before the request lifts acceptance by +30.2%**. Never pitch in the request (Lara Acosta: reference their content + an overlap + a light nod).

Script:

"Hey [Name] — your post on [specific point, e.g. killing volume to fix deliverability] hit home. We run cold-email systems for B2B founders and I've been making the same argument with our own campaign numbers. Would be good to have you in my network."

7. DMs — attraction, not pitch-slapping (per scenario)

The frame (Jasmin Alić + Lara Acosta): *"the selling comes from the sharing."* Lara's **"ask permission to sell" / EduSales** — soft conversation *after* they engage. Hard rule: **60-day patience — no pitch for 60 days after connecting**. ~1 in 10 touches sells; the other 9 build credibility (Adam Robinson).

- **(a) Comment-thread → DM:** "Hey [Name] — liked your angle on [thing]. Genuinely curious, not pitching: how's outbound running at [Company] right now — in-house, or stalled?"
- **(b) Lead-magnet delivery:** "Here's the Cold Email System Audit you asked for → [link]. It scores your setup on the 5 things that predict reply rate. Once you run it — what part of your outbound are you least happy with?"
- **(c) Re-engage a profile viewer:** "Saw you stopped by my profile [Name] — no agenda. If something in your outbound isn't landing, happy to be a sounding board. What are you working on?"
- **(d) Warm follow-up (proof):** "You've been following the cold-email systems stuff, so it's clearly on your mind. We just pulled \$42K pipeline in 10 days off 896 emails for a client doing exactly [their situation]. Happy to walk you through how the system's built — no pitch, just the mechanics. Worth 15 min?"

8. The arsenal — what we already own and how we max it

We are not starting from scratch. This is a **built system we haven't switched on**.

Asset	Status	Use it to the max
Chrome comment extension (suggests 3 real comments in our voice)	LIVE, free	The whole commenting pillar, ready today — 30-min daily block on cold-email posts
Engagement Hub (<code>/engagement</code>)	LIVE	Daily commenting worklist — every fresh post worth engaging, newest first
Networking system (<code>capture-connects.mjs</code> + <code>/networking</code>)	LIVE, free	Harvests <i>pre-qualified</i> connection targets from experts' comment sections
<code>/linkedin-post</code> + <code>/linkedin-batch</code> skills	Built (post skill pre-launch)	Draft on-brand posts from proven hooks + structures; batch a week in one sitting
6,642-post corpus + Template/Format/Structure libraries	LIVE	Steal the highest comment-ratio structures; no freehand hooks
Visual pipeline (<code>make-gif</code> / <code>render-png</code> , brand-locked)	LIVE (5 posts rendered)	A visual on every post at zero design cost
Analytics dashboard (best-day, post-type, comment-heatmap)	Built (needs live data)	The feedback loop — double down on what wins after each week
~50 competitor lead magnets + 1 built magnet	Banked, under-used	Each = a post series + a better-magnet blueprint

Biggest under-used assets: (1) the comment extension + Engagement Hub — free and ready *now*; (2) the ~50 competitor lead magnets; (3) the Networking/Connects system (the entire connecting pillar, idle); (4) analytics (dark only because no real post has closed the loop yet).

Three things gate full automation, all deliberately left for Sophiya: rotate the Apify key, activate the n8n comment/creator pipeline, and run /linkedin-post to a first real published post. The manual posting + commenting + connecting stack works today without any of them.

9. The 14-day launch plan

Where we are → where we should be (Day 14)

Metric	Now	Day 14 target
Posts / week	0.7	4 (Tue/Wed/Thu + 1, zero gaps)
Comments given / week	0	60–75
Connection requests / week	~0	60–75
Impressions / 7 days	939	3,000–4,000
Profile views / week	~22	120–160
Winner rate	~1%	~15–25% (1–2 of 8 posts)
Followers / week	+68	+120–160 (real jump lags to week 3)

The honest framing: weeks 1–2 don't win on followers (a lagging vanity number). They win on **impressions, profile views, and DMs opened** — the leading indicators that become pipeline.

Day	Post	Comment	Connect
1 Mon (setup)	— build day	5 warm-ups	build the Power List (25–30 targets)
2 Tue	P3: "I sent 50,000 cold emails last quarter. The 400 that booked meetings had one thing in common — and it wasn't volume." + comment 'SIGNAL' magnet	12	10
3 Wed	P1: "The exact Clay table we use to spot a company that just hired its first SDR — before they shop for tools."	13	12
4 Thu	P2: "We booked 27 meetings for a B2B SaaS client in 30 days. The campaign, the copy, the 3 numbers that mattered."	13	12
5 Fri	Story: "18 months ago I was copy-pasting cold emails at 2am. The moment I decided to automate myself out of a job."	12	12
6–7 Sat/Sun	no post	6–8 engage-only	6–8 · Sun: batch-draft week 2
8 Mon (review)	—	8	10 · weekly review
9 Tue	P3: "Your 8% reply rate is a vanity metric. Here's the only cold-email number that pays rent."	14	14
10 Wed	P1: "I automated our entire reply-triage with n8n + Claude Code. The flow that saves ~10 hrs/week."	14	14
11 Thu	P2: "A founder sent me his cold email. 0.4% reply rate. The 4 changes that 6x'd it."	14	14
12 Fri	Story: "I almost shut Bleed AI down in month 4. The pivot that saved it."	12	12
13–14 Sat/Sun	no post	6–8	review + lock the habit + draft week 3

Weekly review (Mon, 20 min): winner rate + which pillar won · impressions & profile-view delta · which threads became DMs · prune + refill the Power List to 30 · re-batch next week's 4 drafts.

The daily rhythm we end on

30-minute floor (every weekday, non-negotiable): 0–5 reply to all comments/DMs · 5–20 comment on 8–10 Power-List posts · 20–27 send 10 connection requests · 27–30 capture one post idea.

60-minute engine (post days): 0–10 publish + reply to first comments · 10–15 seed the first real comment (a question) · 15–35 comment on 12–15 posts (5 big creators + 8–10 ICP) · 35–50 send 15 connection requests · 50–58 open 2–3 warm DMs · 58–60 log the numbers + confirm tomorrow's draft.

The rule that makes it work: posts are drafted the *night before* (or batch-drafted Sunday). The morning session is for *distribution*, never for staring at a blank draft.

10. Phase 2 (after the engine is lit) — video + automation

We **finalise posting + commenting + connecting first**. Only once the 14-day engine is a habit do we add:

- **Weekend video** — Taha records 1–2 videos over the weekend. A lightweight "**top video/workflow topic suggester**" (built off the corpus + our own winning posts) proposes what to talk about, so recording is never a

blank page.

- **Activate the automation** we've already built: rotate the Apify key + turn on the n8n comment/creator pipeline (unsupervised, so only with Sophiya present), and close the analytics loop with `sync-post-stats` + `sync-account-posts`.
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11. The ask

Approve the 14-day Phase-1 sprint: **4 posts/week, the daily commenting block, the connection routine — using the tools we already own, drafted and coached daily.** Two weeks from now we review the leading indicators (impressions ~5×, profile views 3–5×, first DMs) and decide whether to scale into Phase 2. Cost is time — **30 minutes a day, non-negotiable; 60 on post days** — and the discipline to not skip it.

Backed throughout by: Lara Acosta (SMPV, every-line-a-hook, EduSales), Pierre Herubel (3-pillar model, anti-commodity test), Adam Robinson (build-in-public, transparency, 1-in-10 sells), Matt Gray (own-a-word), Justin Welsh, Jasmin Alić (comment 20–30/day, hook+rehook), Ruben Hassid (55-char hooks), Casey Brown (peer-not-fan, Power List), Michel Lieben (30/30 ritual, +30.2% acceptance), and LinkedIn's own 2025 "360Brew" algorithm research + van der Blom's 1.8M-post report + AuthoredUp studies.